THE SOUTHERN EXPANSION

KARNATAKA

★ BASAVARAJ BOMMAI
From: JD (S) to BJP in 2008
USP: Son of former Janata stalwart S.R. Bommai, he carried his father's legacy and, as CM, represents the powerful Lingayat community.

BASAVARAJ HORATTI
From: Janata Dal (Secular) to BJP in 2022
USP: Was chairman, Karnataka Legislative Council, eight times MLC. Is now BJP's MLC

PRAMOD MADHWARAJ
From: Congress to BJP in 2022
USP: Was state PCC Vice President and now working to expand BJP



K. SUDHAKAR
From: Congress to BJP in 2019
USP: He was MLA, Chikkaballapur and is now Minister for Health & Family Welfare, Medical Education Department. And is most trusted minister of the chief minister

DR UMESH JADHAV
From: Congress to BJP in 2019
USP: Is former Congress MLA from Chincholi and at present BJP's MP from Gulbarga. Mallikarjuna Kharge lost to him

★ SHOBHA KARANDLAJE
From: KJP to BJP in 2014
USP: Left BJP in 2012 with B.S. Yediyurappa. Currently minister of state for agriculture

RAMESH JARKIHOLI
From: Congress to BJP in 2019
USP: Eldest sibling from powerful Jarkiholi family of Belgaum, MLA of Gokak

★ RAJEEV CHANDRASEKHAR
From: Independent to BJP in 2018
USP: Former telecom pioneer brings his vast media holdings to the BJP's advantage

S.T. SOMASHEKAR
From: Congress to BJP in 2019
USP: Former Congress MLA, is now Minister of Co-operative. Among first of 16 MLAs to resign in 2019 to topple the JD(S)- Congress coalition

KERALA

A.P. ABDULLAHKUTTY
From: Congress to BJP in June 2019
USP: A Muslim face of BJP in Kerala, Abdullahkutty –is two times CPI (M) parliamentarian before he joined Congress. He is now chairperson, central Hajj panel

TELANGANA

D.K. ARUNA
From: Congress to BJP in 2019
USP: Now BJP's national vice president, she is co-in-charge of the party's affairs in Karnataka. She is from an influential Reddy family of Mahbubnagar, and lost the Lok Sabha poll from there to Manne Srinivas Reddy of the TRS

M. RAGHUNANDAN RAO
From: TRS to BJP in 2014
USP: Was TRS politburo member and Medak district convenor. He is now BJP's MLA from Dubbaka and secretary in the state unit

G. VIVEKANAND
From: TRS to BJP in 2019
USP: Former MP from Peddapalli and was adviser to the TRS

EATALA RAJENDER
From: TRS to BJP in June 2021
USP: Former Finance Minister in TRS government, he joined the BJP. He won the Huzarabad assembly byelection by a wide margin

B. BHIKSHAMAIAH GOUD
From: TRS to BJP in 2022
USP: Former Congress MLA, had joined BJP after spending three years in TRS

K. VISHWESHWAR REDDY
From: Congress to BJP in 2022
USP: Elected MP on a TRS ticket in 2014, he lost on a Congress ticket in 2019

